Oct 14, 2025

Meeting Oct 14, 2025 at 15:49 CEST

Meeting records 🎬 Recording

Summary

Clément Lacaille asked for a volunteer to take notes for the meeting and welcomed Naweed Zahed, emphasizing that the process is a learning experience for everyone. Clément Lacaille and Naweed Zahed discussed automating job applications using AI, starting with uploading a resume and brief to generate a list of suitable jobs using ChatGPT and N8N. Clément Lacaille, Naim Burrack, Naweed Zahed, Hana Abrham Tekle, Shivashanti_, Inken Maria Koch, Permila Ostuwar, and Mikheili Chikhashvili worked through troubleshooting various technical issues related to file handling, API keys, and workflow execution within N8N and Google Drive.

Details

Notes Length: Standard

- **Volunteer for Note-Taking** Clément Lacaille asked for a volunteer to take notes for the meeting and welcomed Naweed Zahed, emphasizing that the process is a learning experience for everyone. Clément also requested that all questions and engagement be posted in the Slack group instead of Google Chat, to ensure visibility for the course development team.
- **Understanding the Workflow Diagram** Clément asked Naweed to explain a mind map diagram, which Naweed identified as a workflow or direction for automating job applications using AI. Naweed explained that the process starts with uploading a resume and a brief, followed by AI searching for suitable jobs and automatically applying for them.

- **Job Search Criteria and Company Research** Naweed further detailed the workflow, explaining that after the initial search, jobs are narrowed down based on criteria such as location, salary, and position level. Naweed clarified that researching companies involves examining their size, culture, staff, and working conditions to determine suitability and to tailor resumes and cover letters for specific applications.
- **Focusing on the Initial Automation Goal** Clément explained that the immediate goal for the session was to automate the first part of the workflow: uploading a resume and brief to generate a list of suitable jobs. They decided to use ChatGPT for this purpose and postponed the remaining steps for subsequent sessions.
- **Using the N8N Automation Assistant** Clément introduced a custom ChatGPT assistant, specialized in N8N documentation, to help build the workflow. Clément instructed Naweed to assign the assistant the role of an "automation expert in N8N" and to provide clear context and tasks for the desired automation. Leon Winde questioned the necessity of assigning a role to a specialized bot, and Clément clarified that it helps users develop good prompting habits.
- **Prompting the AI Assistant** Clément guided Naweed in constructing a prompt, emphasizing the need for specific instructions rather than generic ones, such as "to search jobs that fit my profile and interest" from specific websites like LinkedIn and Indeed. They decided to use OpenAI and SERP APIs for the job search and requested the assistant to ask clarifying questions before providing a solution.
- **Troubleshooting ChatGPT Access** Naweed encountered a usage limit with ChatGPT, prompting Clément to seek another volunteer with an active ChatGPT account. Naim Burrack volunteered and shared their screen after ensuring they had sufficient prompts remaining.
- **Interpreting and Responding to the AI's Questions** Naim read through the assistant's questions, which were designed for a 10-year-old, and began answering them. They discussed the format of the resume (PDF) and the preference to manually input job interests rather than having the AI extract skills automatically. Naweed Zahed provided a sharable link to their CV for use in the exercise.
- **Addressing API Key and Output Preferences** Naim informed the assistant that they did not have OpenAI or SERP API keys and expressed a desire for the job search results to be saved in a Google Sheet, and that the workflow should be

triggered manually. Sven Lück raised a question regarding the 250 free searches per month on Z API and whether it would be sufficient for daily company research, prompting a discussion about search parameters.

- **Initiating Workflow Construction in N8N** After confirming API keys, Clément instructed Naim to build the workflow step-by-step in N8N, starting with a manual trigger node and then adding a file read node to extract text from the resume. Naim encountered difficulty finding the correct node and was advised by Clément to take a screenshot and ask ChatGPT for more detailed guidance.
- **Addressing File Handling and Cloud Version Specifics** Naim continued to troubleshoot the file reading process, and Clément clarified that the AI might have assumed the file was on a local computer. Clément then instructed Naim to inform the AI that they were using a cloud version of N8N and that the resume was in Google Drive. The process then moved to adding a Google Drive node to download the resume, with Naim needing to upload their own resume to their Google Drive for the exercise.
- **File Download and Extraction** Clément Lacaille and Naim Burrack discussed the process of downloading a file from Google Drive and extracting its contents using an "extract from PDF" node in N8N. Naim Burrack successfully downloaded their file and confirmed the text appeared as a JSON file. Clément Lacaille emphasized the difference between JSON, the language for tools, and Table, the human-readable format.
- **Troubleshooting Trigger Issues** Murphy Odion Usunobun encountered an issue with the "trigger" step, prompting Clément Lacaille to suggest restarting the process by deleting everything and reconfiguring. Naim Burrack demonstrated the initial steps, including configuring the N8N connection with Google Drive and manually triggering the "download file" option.
- **Resolving Credential Problems** Clément Lacaille addressed a common issue where users lose credentials, explaining how to re-establish them by editing the credential part and re-signing in with Google. Naim Burrack demonstrated removing and re-entering the client secret, emphasizing the importance of not including "https" or slashes at the beginning of the credentials.
- **File Selection and Output Field** Naim Burrack explained the next steps for downloading a file, which involve selecting the Google Drive, choosing "download" as the operation, searching for the desired PDF file, and ensuring "output file in field" is set to "data". Naim Burrack clarified that for the

cloud-based N8N version, a local file path is not needed because it cannot connect to a local machine.

- **Assisting with File Location Issues** Hana Abrham Tekle faced difficulty finding their CV file despite having uploaded it to Google Drive. Clément Lacaille identified the problem as Hana Abrham Tekle mistakenly using "Sugandha's drive" instead of their own. Clément Lacaille guided Hana Abrham Tekle through creating a new credential and naming their Google Drive correctly to resolve the issue.
- **Addressing Execution and Login Problems** Shivashanti_ reported a "forbidden" error when trying to select files, and Naweed Zahed mentioned being unable to sign in to their Google account. Clément Lacaille advised them to use perplexity first for troubleshooting and offered further assistance after the class.
- **Handling Workflow Execution Stalls** Inken Maria Koch and Leon Winde experienced their workflow execution getting stuck. Leon Winde suggested canceling the execution, and Clément Lacaille showed how to stop the workflow, save, and refresh before re-running it.
- **Integrating OpenAI for Resume Analysis** Naim Burrack introduced the next step of adding an OpenAI chat node and selecting either GPT-4 or GPT-3.5 as the model. Clément Lacaille and Naim Burrack discussed how to use perplexity for guidance when confused about which options to choose within the OpenAI node. Naim Burrack explained that the system message tells the AI its role, while the user message is the specific request.
- **Crafting Search Queries with OpenAI** The goal was to analyze a resume and find fitting job titles and to generate a boolean search string for job searching. Clément Lacaille explained that a boolean search string is a smart search query using "and," "or," and "not" for precise online searches. Naim Burrack then demonstrated copying and pasting the system and user messages provided by perplexity into the OpenAI node, ensuring the system message was set to "system" and the user message correctly pointed to the resume text.
- **Understanding JSON and Customizing Searches** Naim Burrack explained JSON as a computer-readable data format using key-value pairs, with "skills," "interests," and "location" as examples of keys. Clément Lacaille explained that values like "backend developer" or "content creator" change based on individual search needs. Naim Burrack clarified how to set the location and prioritize job titles within the user message to customize the search.

- **Reviewing OpenAI Output and Next Steps** After executing the OpenAI node, Naim Burrack showed the output, which included skills, interests, location, and a boolean query in JSON format. Clément Lacaille asked Naim Burrack to use perplexity to determine which output information was most relevant for job searching. Clément Lacaille concluded the class by having participants share screenshots of their completed workflows on Slack to demonstrate engagement.
- **Resume Upload Process** Clément Lacaille guided Permila Ostuwar through the process of uploading a resume to Google Drive and then selecting it within the NAM system. They emphasized the importance of uploading the file to Google Drive first and then selecting it from the provided list in NAM. Permila Ostuwar encountered difficulty in finding the resume file and copying its name, leading to a step-by-step assistance from Clément Lacaille to correctly identify and use the "curriculum mitt" PDF file.
- **Google Drive Privacy Concerns** Mikheili Chikhashvili raised a concern about Google Drive privacy within the NAM system, questioning why they could see files from other users' Google Drives. Clément Lacaille acknowledged the issue, stating that it "is not supposed to happen" unless specific client secrets are shared. They indicated that they would investigate solutions to restrict access to only certain files and would provide an answer by the next day, noting the sensitivity of using the cloud version where all IDs are entered.
- **Meeting Conclusion and Engagement Request** Clément Lacaille concluded the meeting by asking if there were any further questions, offering to address them if possible. They requested that participants upload their progress, even if minimal, to Slack to demonstrate engagement and the value provided by the sessions. Clément Lacaille thanked everyone for their participation and expressed anticipation for completing the automation tasks together during the week.

Suggested next steps

- [ ] Clément Lacaille will solve the problem of the chat GPT limit tomorrow.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will continue the class tomorrow.
- [ ] Shivashanti_ will take a screenshot of the error and paste it in publicity to see what it says first.
- [ ] Naim Burrack will copy and paste the system and user message in the Google chat window.

- [ ] Permila Ostuwar will follow the remaining instructions through recording to complete the task and come back tomorrow.
- [ ] Clément Lacaille will investigate and propose a solution by tomorrow for restricting access to Google Drive files.
- [ ] The group will upload their status on Slack, even if it's just two notes, to show engagement.